

Table 1: Localisation status of the main components of free software

Language	India Speakers (Census 2001, in millions)	Wheezy Debian Installer Level 1	GNOME 3.4#	Firefox 11.0	LibreOffice 3.5.1#
Assamese	13.0	NA	Release	Release	NA
Bengali	83.0	Release	Release	Release	Release
Bodo	1.4	NA	NA	NA	Beta
Dogri	2.3	NA	NA	NA	Beta
Gujarati	46.0	Release	Release	Release	Release
Hindi*	258.0	Release	Release	Release	Release
Kannadav	38.0	Release	Release	Release	Release
Kashmiri	5.5	NA	NA	NA	Beta
Konkani	2.5	NA	NA	NA	Beta
Maithili	12.0	NA	Beta	Beta	Beta
Malayalam	33.0	Release	Release	Release	Release
Manipuri	1.5	NA	NA	NA	Beta
Marathi	72.0	Release	Release	Release	Release
Nepali	2.9	Release	Beta	NA	Beta
Oriya	33.0	NA	Release	Release	Release
Punjabi	29.0	Release	Release	Release	Release
Sanskrit	0.01	NA	NA	NA	Beta
Santhali	6.5	NA	NA	NA	Beta
Sindhi	2.5	NA	NA	NA	Beta
Tamil	61.0	Release	Release	Beta	Release
Telugu	74.0	Release	Release	Release	Release
Urdu	52.0	NA	NA	NA	NA

* There are 422 million Hindi speakers, if you include those who speak its various dialects.

A 75 per cent translation of the GNOME and LibreOffice UI is taken as usable localisation.

- There are eight languages that have 100 per cent release-level coverage of all components.
- All Indian languages (barring Urdu) have release or beta versions of LibreOffice.
- Localisation efforts appear to have been prioritised in the following order: LibreOffice, GNOME, Firefox and Debian installer.
- Some Indian languages like Hindi, Tamil and Bangla are international in nature, and have benefited from worldwide contributors. The exception seems to be Urdu.

The user statistics

Localisation will improve only when there are users, so it is good to understand the user statistics. For FOSS, it is not easy to find out the extent of language use, as software is freely distributed. Firefox has a facility called Blocklist, which is used to ensure security for users by helping with warnings about suspicious sites, add-ons, etc. This feature records the preferences of

Firefox users, each time they use the browser. Hence, the Firefox statistics are a good indicator of usage. From both the reading and editing perspective, the statistics of Wikipedia, the fifth-largest Internet site, have also been considered. Apart from this, bloggers constitute an important segment of language computing. The analysis of a bloggers' survey done by the *Indibloggers.in* portal has been used as another indicator. Table 2 shows the statistics of users for a sample of Indian languages.

A careful look at this table reveals that Indic users are a very tiny fraction of those who speak local languages. Hindi, Marathi, Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam and Bengali are ahead of the rest. Urdu registers its presence in Wikipedia and the bloggers' world.

Potential for growth

The recently released Census 2011 data on households with computers provides a rich source of information on the scope for using Indian languages. Of 246 million